

Day 7 — Why Eclipses Happen

Module: Moon Phases and Tithi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Explain solar/lunar eclipses using orbital plane geometry (5° tilt of Moon's orbit).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *pūrṇimā* (IAST: pūrṇimā; lit. "full moon")
- Sometimes the Moon hides the Sun — that's a *solar eclipse*!
- Sometimes the Earth's shadow falls on the Moon — that's a *lunar eclipse*!

Use the torch + ball + child's head from earlier days. Show: - Ball blocks light → solar eclipse (child's face goes dark). - Child's head blocks light → lunar eclipse (ball goes dark).

SAFETY RULE: Never look at the Sun with eyes! Children repeat 3 times.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *10-Day Moon Observation Diary* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.